

Application Responses

Grant: 2026-27 Scholarship Program Round 1, Higher Education, Study in Australia's Northern Territory

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What are you studying now, and where?

I am in the final semester of a Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Engineering at Himalayan Institute of Technology in Kathmandu, Nepal. I graduate in December 2026. I have accepted an offer to start a Master of Data Science at Charles Darwin University in Darwin in Semester 1, 2027.

Academic achievements

I rank 3rd in a cohort of 142 students, with a GPA of 3.84 out of 4.0. I received the Dean's Merit Award in 2023, 2024 and 2025. My final year project, a low bandwidth crop disease detection app for farmers in Gorkha district, won first place at the National Student Innovation Showcase 2025 and was published as a short paper at the Himalayan Computing Conference. I also scored 7.5 overall in IELTS Academic (August 2026).

Leadership

In 2022 I founded Code Pahadi, a free weekend coding club for girls in rural schools. It started with 9 students in one classroom and now runs in 6 schools with more than 180 participants and 14 volunteer mentors, most of them my former students. Two graduates have since won places in engineering programs. I served as President of the Women in Technology Society at my institute in 2024, where I tripled membership from 40 to 125 and negotiated 12 paid internships with local employers. In 2025 I led a team of 6 volunteers to deliver digital skills training to 300 villagers after the Gorkha floods, helping 41 small businesses move their orders online.

How will studying in the NT contribute to your future and the Northern Territory?

The Northern Territory faces a problem I know well: spread out communities, patchy connectivity and limited access to data skills. In Nepal I have built tools for exactly these conditions, so I want to learn how to do it at a larger scale. The Master of Data Science at Charles Darwin University, which is accredited by the Australian Computer Society, includes units such as Data Analytics and Advanced Data Management that match my goals. Its Casuarina campus and its links with Territory agencies, health services and industry are a major reason I chose Darwin.

During my studies I plan to volunteer with local community organisations, mentor other international students and join Territory hackathons. After graduating I want to work in the Territory, ideally in a government or health data role, helping agencies use data to plan services for remote communities. I would also like to start a Code Pahadi chapter in Darwin to encourage girls and young women into technology. I want to give back to the place that gave me this opportunity, and to build my career here for the long term.